

Linking Left-Hand Slides

It takes a quarter note to slide up to a note from a lower note on the same string, so two identical slides can be played consecutively if they are spaced a quarter note apart in time and three or less frets apart on the fretboard (three frets is the maximum distance your left-hand fingers – your pinky and your index finger – can span comfortably on the fretboard, especially when you're down by the nut). If you begin and end your slides on adjacent frets, you can play up to four slides in succession (this would take four quarter notes) – each finger (your index finger, your middle finger, your ring finger, and your pinky finger) can be used for one slide. To shift positions with your left hand to restart this slide sequence, one and a half quarter notes (three eighth notes) are required.